ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LINGUISTICS 2B

Analysing Conversation

University of Glasgow

Faces and Threats

Marc Alexander

Week 3

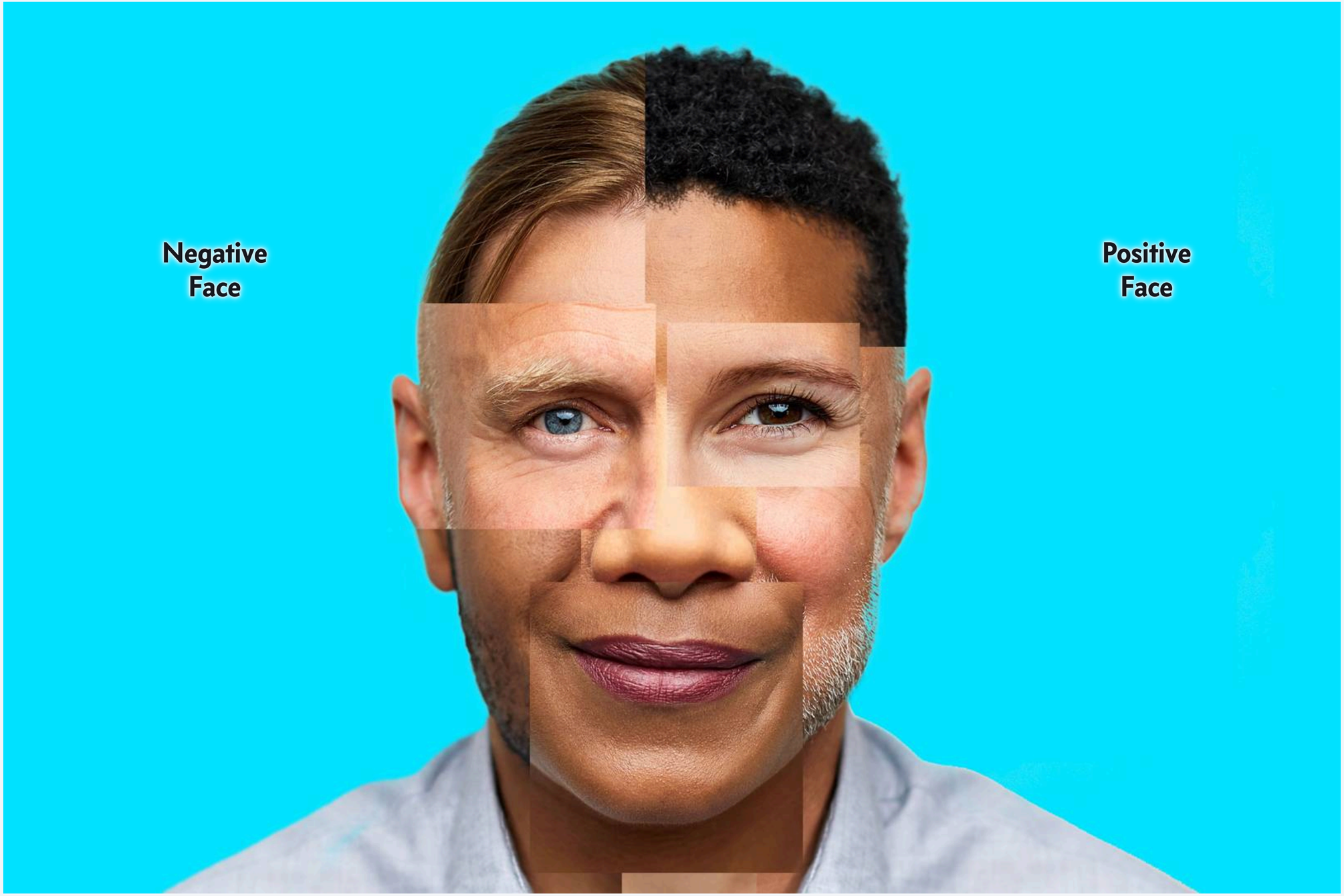
Ends

Will

Rationality

Face




Negative
Face
Positive
Face

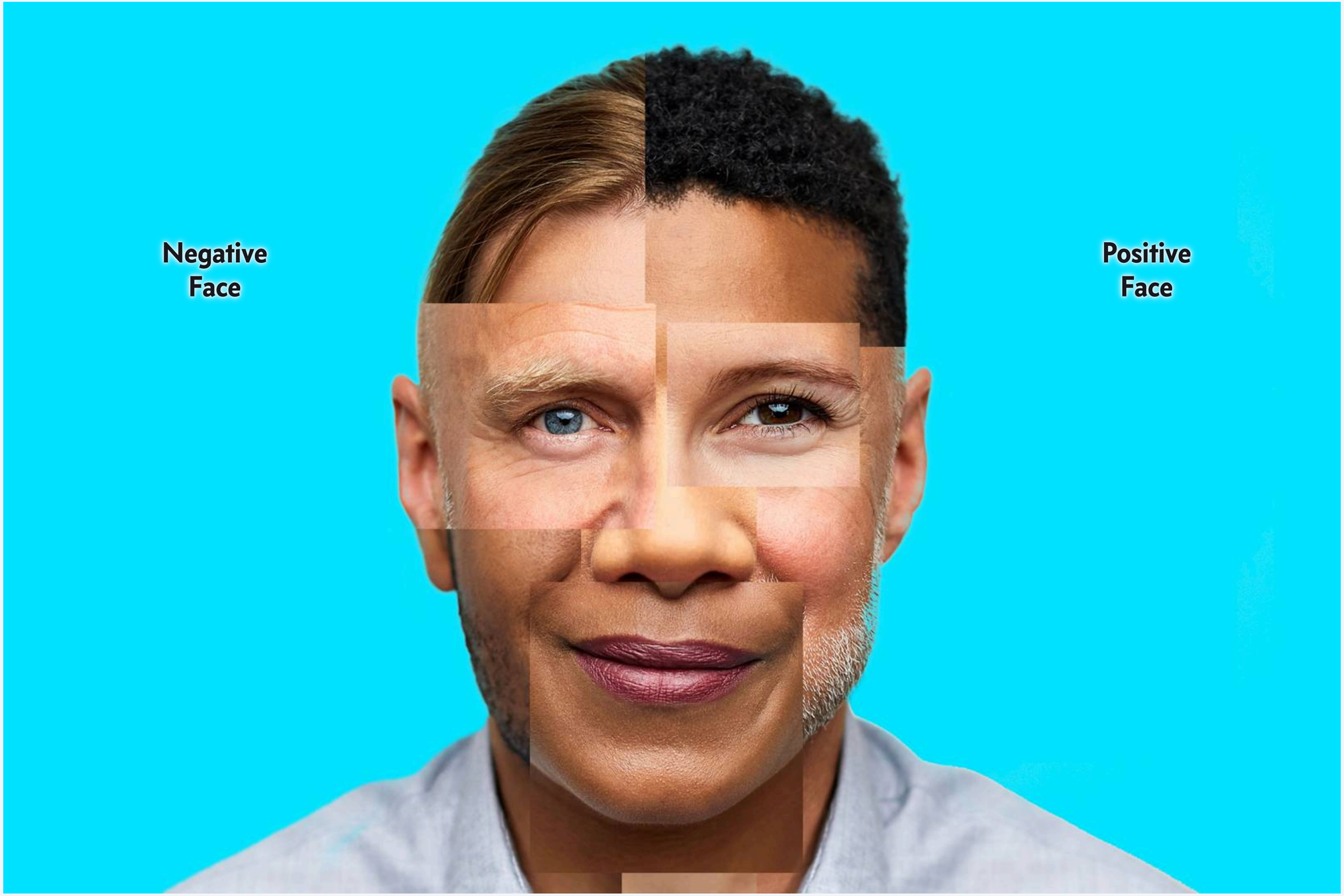




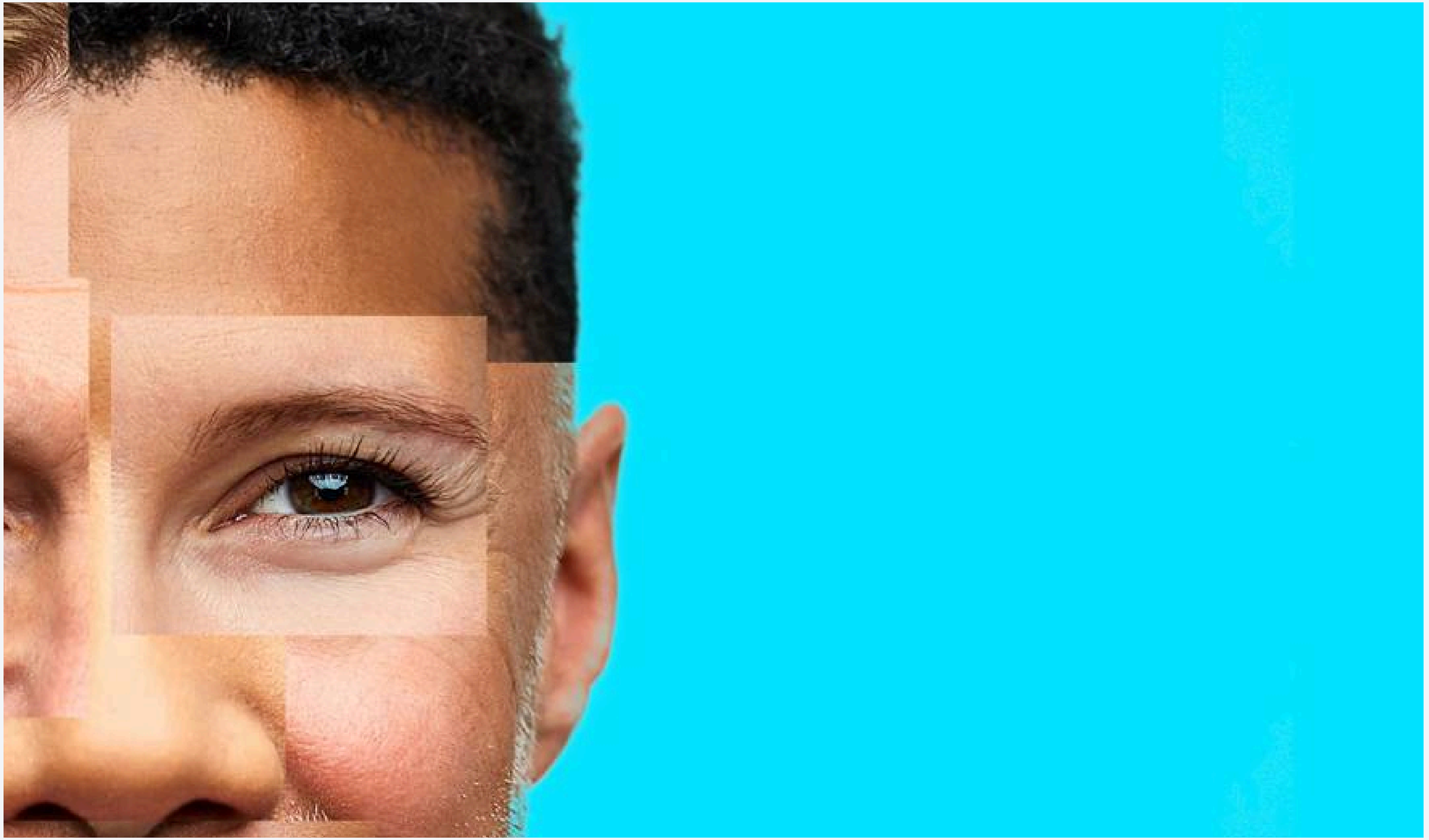
Negative Face

- **the need for privacy**
- **the freedom to pursue your own goals**
- freedom of action and freedom from imposition
- the desire for one’s actions be unimpeded by others




Negative
Face
Positive
Face

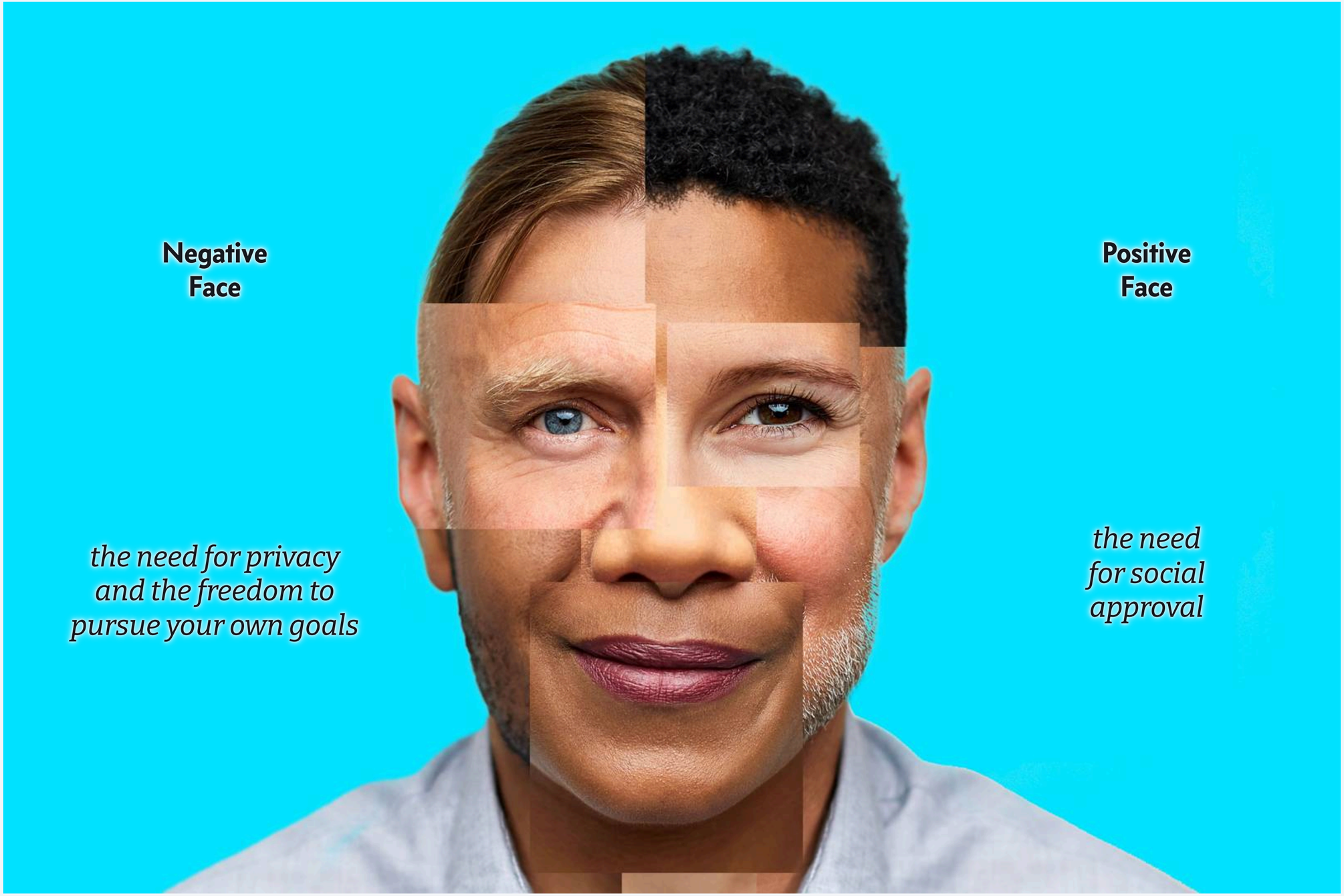






Positive Face

- **the need for social approval**
- one’s positive consistent self-image, including the desire that this self-image be appreciated and approved of
- the desire that one’s wants be desirable to at least some others


Negative
Face
Positive
Face
the need for privacy
and the freedom to
pursue your own goals
the need
for social
approval

politeness

politeness



politeness
(facework)

ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LINGUISTICS 2B

Analysing Conversation

Face Threatening Acts

Face

Threatening

Act

FTA

FTA

- **negative face**: *the need for privacy and the freedom to pursue your own goals*
  - Linguistically threatened by: INTRUSIONS, COMMANDS, REQUESTS, ADVICE, REMINDERS, etc
- **positive face**: *the need for social approval*
  - Linguistically threatened by: INSULTS, ANGER, REFUSALS, INTERRUPTIONS, INATTENTION, etc


FTA









Rate of imposition



Social distance



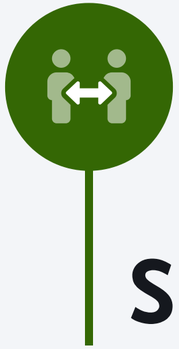
Power relationship

Rate of imposition

Can I borrow your...

- *pen*
- *car*
- *dog*
- *wife/husband*
- *life savings*







Social distance

Dear Professor Smith, We haven't met but I wonder if I could possibly ask you…

Hi Fraser, Can I ask a question about…

Hey nerd, what's up with…

Power relationship

Excuse me, ma'am, but would it be all right if I were to close the window?

Mind me closing the window?

You there, close the bloody window!

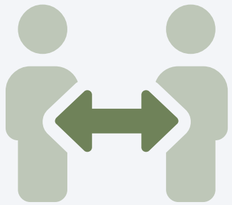


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RATE OF IMPOSITION

+



SOCIAL DISTANCE

+



POWER RELATIONSHIP

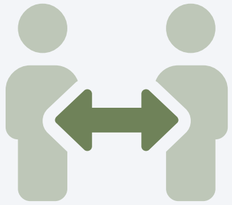


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RATE OF IMPOSITION

+



SOCIAL DISTANCE

+



POWER RELATIONSHIP

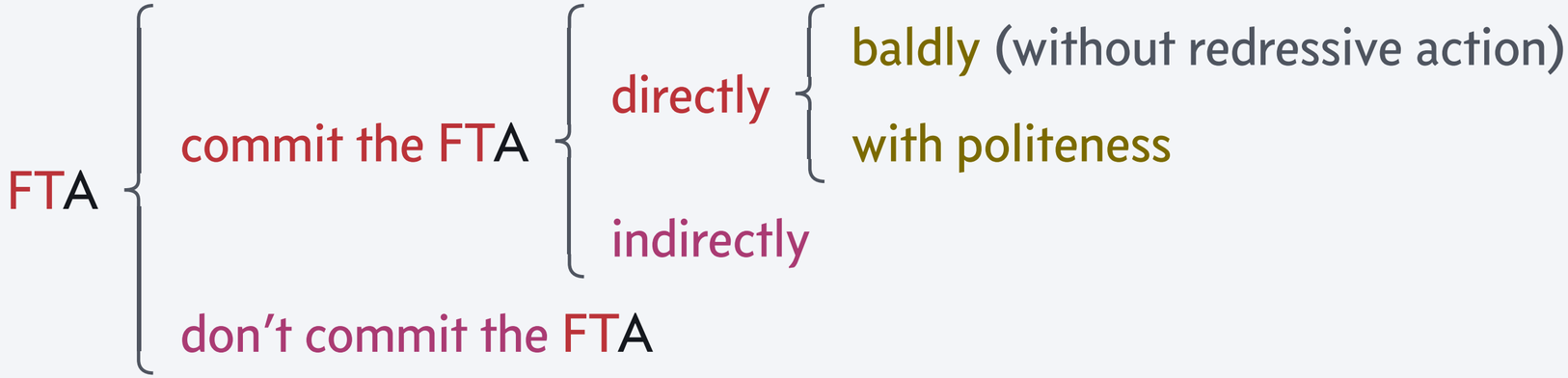
$$W_{FTA} = R + D_{S \rightarrow H} + P_{H \rightarrow S}$$

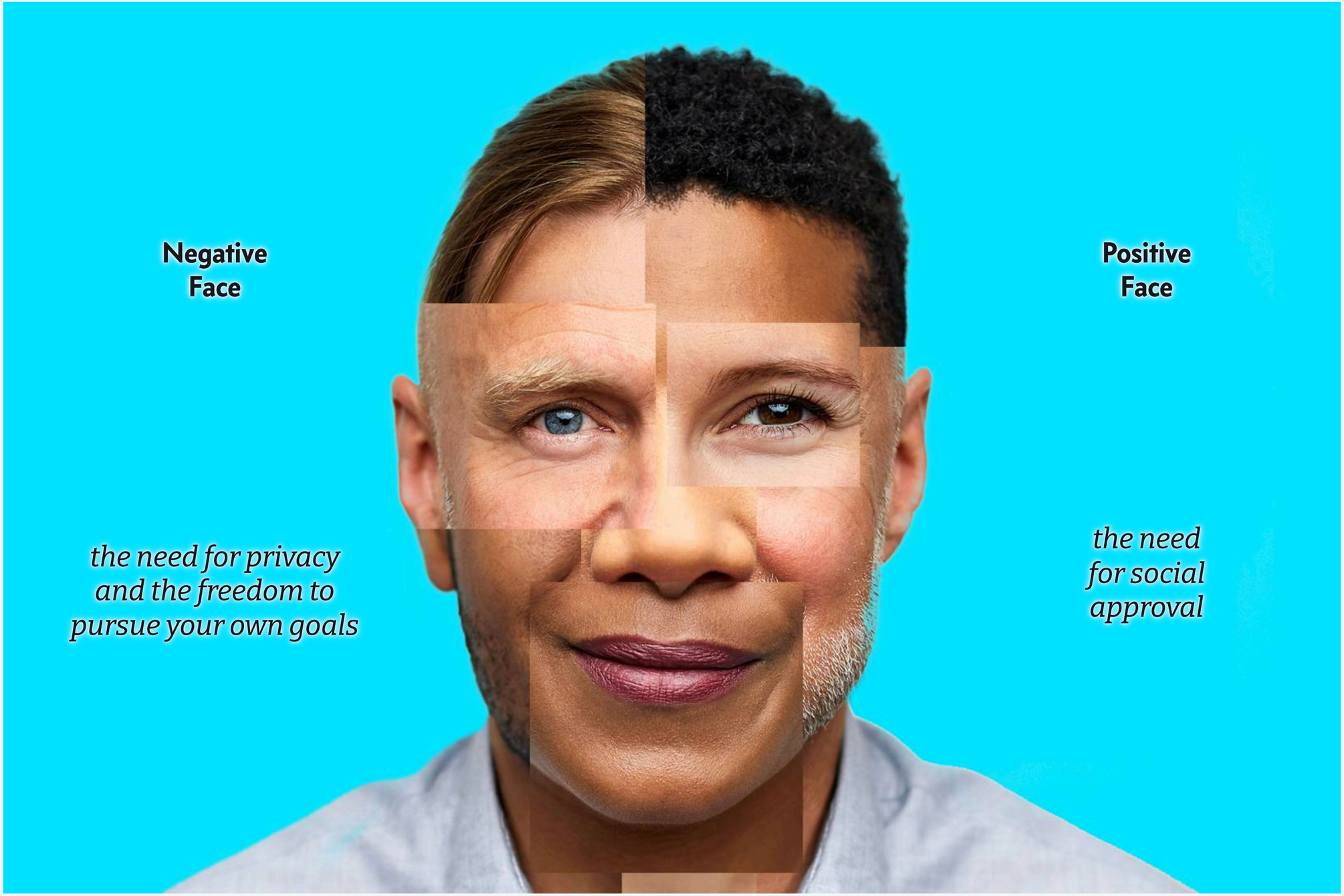
ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LINGUISTICS 2B

Analysing Conversation

Politeness

FTA


FTA
commit the FTA
directly
baldly (without redressive action)
with politeness
indirectly
don't commit the FTA


Negative
Face
Positive
Face
the need for privacy
and the freedom to
pursue your own goals
the need
for social
approval

Negative Politeness

Aimed at negative face: not infringing another's domain and minimizing the impact of the FTA

Positive Politeness

Aimed at positive face: sociable behaviour, such as compliments, which show an awareness of the hearer's needs and point of view

Negative Politeness

POLITENESS STRATEGY	LINGUISTIC FORM
Don't presume	Question
Give hearer options	Be pessimistic
Minimize FTA	Make explicit rate of imposition
Redress other wants	Go on record as owing or forgiving a debt
Communicate desire not to impose	Apologise
Disassociate from imposition	Avoid first-person pronouns, state as general rule

Negative Politeness

Aimed at negative face: not infringing another's domain and minimizing the impact of the FTA

Positive Politeness

Aimed at positive face: sociable behaviour, such as compliments, which show an awareness of the hearer's needs and point of view

Positive Politeness

POLITENESS STRATEGY	LINGUISTIC FORM
Claim common ground	Attend to hearer's interests, seek agreement, joke, state common ground
Show admiration/interest	Exaggerate interest/approval/sympathy for hearer
Convey cooperation	Show concern for hearer's wants, give reasons
Claim reflexivity	Be optimistic, include the hearer in the activity
Fulfil one of hearer's desires	Give something to hearer (eg things, sympathy, understanding, cooperation)